# Milena Jessen

University of Bonn
Niebuhrstrasse 5, 1.009
53113 Bonn, Germany

Citizenship: German
Email: milena.jessen@uni-bonn.de

## Research Interests

Behavioral Economics, Experimental Economics, Behavioral Finance

## Education

| | |
|---|---|
| **2022 - 28 (exp.)** | Ph.D. in Economics, University of Bonn<br>Advisors: Prof. Florian Zimmermann, Prof. Botond Kőszegi |
| **2026** | Visiting Student Researcher, California Institute of Technology<br>Host: Prof. Kirby Nielsen |
| **2022 - 24** | M.Sc. in Economic Research (1.2, *with distinction*), University of Bonn |
| **2022 - 23** | Visiting Ph.D. Student, University of California, Berkeley |
| **2019 - 22** | B.Sc. in Economics (1.0, *with distinction*), University of Bonn |
| **2021 - 22** | Visiting Undergraduate Student, University of Toronto |
| **2018 - 19** | B.Sc. in Psychology (*not completed*), University of Hamburg |

## Affiliations

| | |
|---|---|
| **2025 -** | Contract holder, Cluster of Excellence ECONtribute: Markets & Public Policy |
| **2024 -** | Co-opted Member, CRC TR 224 Economic Perspectives on Societal Challenges |
| **2022 -** | Doctoral Student, Bonn Graduate School of Economics |
| **2024 - 25** | Associated Member, IZA Institute of Labor Economics |

## Selected Research in Progress

**Hierarchical Representations** (draft available upon request)
Best Paper Award in Behavioral Economics, 2nd Berlin PhD Conference, 2026

## Teaching

| | |
|---|---|
| **Summer 2026** | Instructor, Academic Research Seminar on Behavioral Economics (Undergraduate, University of Bonn) |
| **Fall 2025/26** | Teaching Assistant, Applied Data Analytics (Undergraduate, University of Bonn) |
| **February 2025** | Instructor, Short Course on Complexity (Studienstiftung Winter School in Klosters, Switzerland) |

## Research Positions

| | |
|---|---|
| **2025 -** | YEP Student, Cluster of Excellence ECONtribute: Markets & Public Policy |
| **2024 - 26** | Research Assistant to Prof. Christopher Roth |
| **2021 - 22** | Research Assistant to Prof. Suanna Oh |
| **2019 - 22** | Student Helper, briq Institute on Behavior and Inequality |
| **2020** | Intern, Price and Service Management Group, Fraunhofer Center for International Management and Knowledge Economy |
| **2020** | Intern, International Finance Group, Kiel Institute for the World Economy |
| **2019** | Undergraduate Research Assistant, Max Planck Institute on Collective Goods |
| **2019** | Intern, Cognitive Psychology Group, University of Hamburg |

## Grants

| | |
|---|---|
| **2026** | ECONtribute (5000€) |
| **2026** | Dr. Hans Riegel-Stiftung Connex-Grant (6500€, with Paul Grass and Robin Musolff) |
| **2026** | CRC TR 224 (8220€) |
| **2025** | CRC TR 224 (3600€) |
| **2025** | Behavioral Finance e.V. Research Grant for Junior Researchers (5000€) |
| **2024** | Behavioral Finance e.V. Research Grant for Junior Researchers (5000€, with Paul Grass) |
| **2024** | CRC TR 224 (in total 3500€ without VAT, with Paul Grass) |
| **2024** | IZA Institute of Labor Economics (1000€ without VAT, with Paul Grass) |

## Awards and Scholarships

| | |
|---|---|
| **2026** | Best Paper Award in Behavioral Economics (2000€) at 2nd Berlin PhD Conference |
| **2022 - 25** | Full PhD scholarship, Bonn Graduate School of Economics (BGSE) |
| **2024** | Forum Humanum Fellowship |
| **2020 - 24** | Merit scholarship, German Academic Scholarship Foundation (Studienstiftung) |
| **2021 - 22** | Tuition waiver for Toronto stay, Global Exchange Program, University of Bonn |

## Summer Schools and Workshops

| | |
|---|---|
| **2026** | Russell Sage Foundation Summer Institute in Behavioral Economics (Dedham) |
| **2026** | Yale Summer School in Behavioral Finance (New Haven) |
| **2026** | Spring School in Behavioral Economics (San Diego) |
| **2025** | Summer School and Workshop on Beliefs, Narratives, and Memory (Riederau) |
| **2025** | Caltech CTESS Theory-Based Experiments (Pasadena) |
| **2024** | The Limits of Intelligence: Meaning and Value (New School, New York) |
| **2024** | Survey Data in Economics and Finance (with Michael Weber, Gerzensee) |

| | |
|---|---|
| **2023** | CRC TR 224 21st Century Applied Micro (with Chris Walters and Magne Mogstad, Annweiler am Trifels) |
| **2020** | Topics in Macroeconomics and International Finance (with Matteo Maggiori, Kiel Institute) |

## Presentations and Conference Participation

**2026 (incl. scheduled):** BGSE Applied Microeconomics Workshop (Bonn), Spring School in Behavioral Economics (poster, San Diego), CRC TR 224 Young Researchers Workshop (Mannheim), Bonn-Cologne-Frankfurt-Mannheim PhD Conference (Cologne), Applied Micro Coffee (Bonn), 2nd Berlin PhD Conference (Berlin), SITE Experimental Economics (Stanford), Workshop on Cognitive Economics (Herrsching), ESA European Meeting (Barcelona), VfS Annual Conference 2026 (Innsbruck), ECONtribute Retreat (poster, Siegburg), Caltech Experimental Coffee Hour (Pasadena), Rady Econ Strat Brown Bag (San Diego), Chapman Brown Bag (Orange)

**2025:** IZA Beliefs Workshop (attendance as guest, Bonn), Summer School and Workshop on Beliefs, Narratives, and Memory (poster, Riederau)

**2024:** Early Career Behavioral Economics Conference (attendance as guest, Bonn), IZA Coffee (Bonn), BGSE Brown Bag (Bonn)

**2022:** SITE Psychology and Economics (attendance as guest, Stanford)

## Professional Service

| | |
|---|---|
| **Refereeing** | Journal of the European Economic Association |
| **2025 -** | CRC TR 224 Young Researchers Representative |
| **2025 -** | Organizer of CRC TR 224 Young Researchers Workshops |
| **2025 -** | Coordinator of PhD Lab Meeting |
| **2023 - 24** | Co-organizer of first-gen academics initiative, BGSE |
| **2022 - 23** | Member of working group on discrimination, Studienstiftung |

## Miscellaneous

| | |
|---|---|
| **Memberships** | griffelkunst-Vereinigung Hamburg e.V. |
| **Programming** | Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, Qualtrics (HTML and JavaScript) |
| **Languages** | German (native), English (fluent), French (good command), Spanish (basic) |

Last update: October 25, 2026